

FLEXIBLE DIETING 101

NUTRITION GUIDE

A RECOV PLAYBOOK

Flexible Dieting *101*

Eat the foods you love and still hit your goals — no rigid meal plans, no guilt, no burnout.

YOUR COACH

Daniel Delahunty

POWERED BY

RECOV

WHAT IT IS

Inclusion, not exclusion.

If rigid meal plans and restrictive diets have failed you before — too strict to stick with — flexible dieting might be exactly what gets you moving again.

Flexible dieting is an approach built on **inclusion over exclusion**: every food has a place in a healthy, enjoyable diet. You hit daily targets for calories and macros — protein, carbs and fat — by choosing from a full range of foods, rather than banning them. The goal is to learn what foods, in what amounts, at what times, make you feel and perform your best — so you feel empowered by your choices instead of controlled by them.

Less guilt, less stress, better adherence. It works for any goal — fat loss, performance or simply feeling healthier — because it's something you can actually sustain.



Daniel Delahunty

CERTIFIED PT & NUTRITION COACH

I've watched too many people white-knuckle a diet for six weeks then quit. Flexible dieting is how my clients stay on track for years — this is the simple version of how it works.

THE 80/20 GUIDELINE

Whole foods first —
your treats still fit.

80%

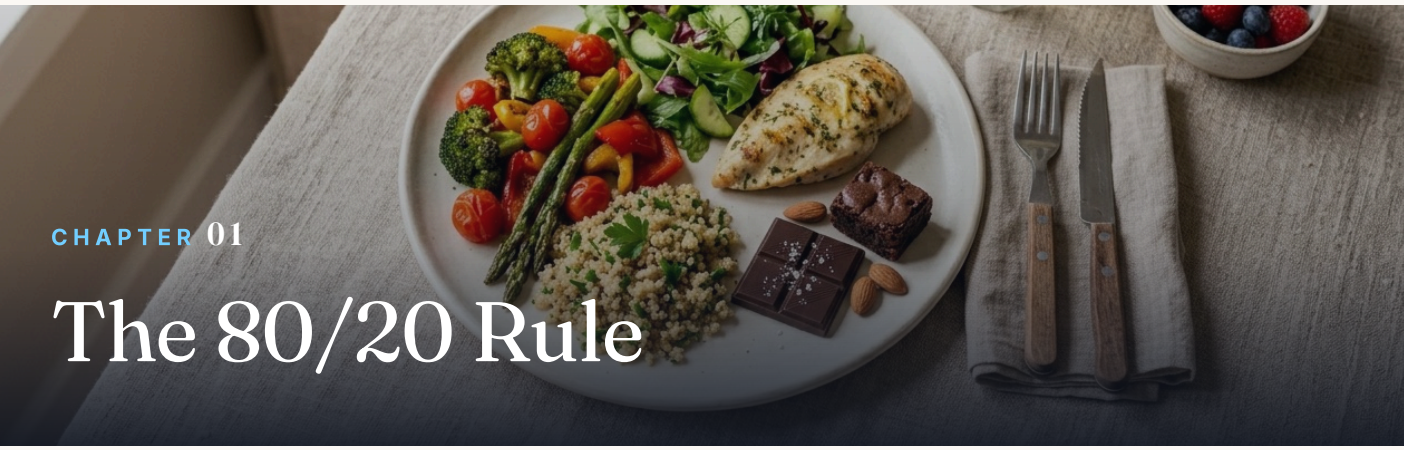
WHOLE FOODS

20%

FOODS YOU LOVE

20g+

FIBRE DAILY



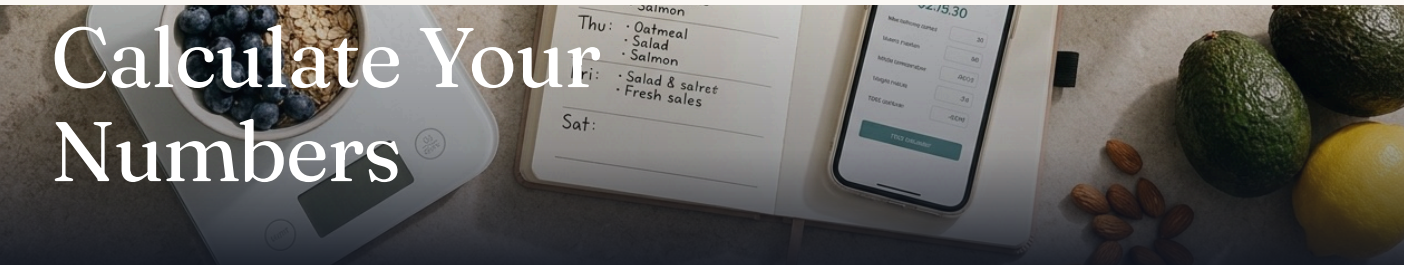
CHAPTER 01

The 80/20 Rule

Flexible dieting doesn't end at counting macros — food quality still matters. The simplest way to balance both is the 80/20 guideline.

Fill **80% of your diet from whole, nutrient-rich foods** — vegetables, fruit, quality carbs, lean meats and healthy fats. Leave the other **20% for the more processed or specialty foods you genuinely love**. You stay flexible, but you also get the micronutrients and fibre that keep your hunger and energy steady.

*Have your treats and enjoy them guilt-free
— just build the base from whole foods first.*



Calculate Your Numbers

Your targets start with one number: how much energy your body burns in a day. Here's how to find it.

Calculate Your Calories

We all need different amounts of food to suit our goals — whether it's fat loss, maintenance or to build muscle. Here's a simple way to find your starting point.

Maintain

CALORIES IN = CALORIES OUT

Lose

CALORIES IN < CALORIES OUT

Build

CALORIES IN > CALORIES OUT

Step 1 — Find your TDEE

Find your **TDEE** — your Total Daily Energy Expenditure. Use a free calculator like **tdecalculator.net** and enter your gender, age, weight, height and activity level to get your daily maintenance calories.

Step 2 — Set your goal

Subtract 300–500 calories from your TDEE for fat loss. This creates a weekly deficit of 2,100–3,500 calories — roughly 0.3–0.5 kg of fat per week. Monitor your weight weekly and adjust as needed; this is an estimate, not an exact science.

Step 3 — Match calories to your goal

Your TDEE is your maintenance number. From there:

- **Fat loss** — eat below your TDEE (a deficit).
- **Weight gain** — eat above your TDEE (a surplus).
- **Maintain** — eat at your TDEE, adjusting as your body changes.



CHAPTER 03

Your Macros

With your calories set, split them across the three macros. Here's what each does and roughly how much to aim for.

4

CAL / G

Protein

Drives cell repair and muscle growth, prevents muscle loss, controls cravings and keeps you full.

Aim: ~2.2–2.8g per kg bodyweight (moderate body fat & training). Leaner / high-training: 2.4–3g/kg. Higher body fat / low training: 1.6–2.2g/kg.

4

CAL / G

Carbohydrates

Your body's optimal energy source — high or low GI, 1g gives 4 calories.

Aim: ~45–65% of total calories, or simply the remainder after protein and fat.

9

CAL / G

Fats

Protects organs, produces and regulates hormones, maintains cell membranes and absorbs key vitamins — the most calorie-dense macro at 9 cal/g.

Aim: ~20–35% of total calories.

Micros, Fibre & Tracking

Macros are only half the story. The details below are what keep you healthy, regular and energised.

Vitamins, minerals & fibre

- Aim for **1–2 serves of fruit and 2–3 serves of vegetables** daily for your micronutrients. A multivitamin can fill genuine gaps.
- Target at least **20g of fibre a day** — fruit, veg, breads and grains — for digestion and steady energy.

How to track

Use a calorie-counting app with a big database — MyFitnessPal is the popular pick. Two cautions: user-entered foods are often inaccurate, and so are app-generated macro targets. Do your own calculations (or have a coach do them), and grab a set of food scales — your eyes will fool you on portions more than you think.

QUICK WINS

- Weigh your portions early on — recalibrate your eye.
- Don't trust app-default targets; calculate your own.
- Hit fibre and produce daily, not just macros.

A photograph of a restaurant table. In the foreground, there is a glass of water with a lime wedge and a plate of food, including a piece of salmon, quinoa, and vegetables. In the background, other diners are seated at tables, slightly out of focus.

CHAPTER 05

Eating Out & Alcohol

The whole point of flexible dieting is that real life still fits. Here's how to handle the two things strict diets ruin.



Eating out

It shouldn't be stressful. Many places list nutrition info — but even when they don't, you can stay on track by deconstructing the meal and estimating its contents to fit your day. Flexible dieting is built for socialising; you don't have to miss the moments that matter.



Alcohol

Not essential, but it can fit — as long as your key macros are mostly met first. Alcohol is calorie-dense at 7 cal/g (~65 cal a glass), so many flexible dieters reach for a vodka & diet soda to keep it lean. The real trap is over-eating after a few drinks — pre-plan and stick to your macros.

*You can keep the treats you love
— just be intentional about when,
where and how you fit them in.*

REFERENCES

McKinley Health Center, University of Illinois — Macronutrients. · Nutrition Australia — Fibre (2014). · Moran LJ et al., *J Clin Endocrinol Metab* 2005. · Farnsworth E et al., *Am J Clin Nutr* 2003. · Layman DK et al., *J Nutr* 2003.

Hit your protein — then absorb it

Protein is the macro most people struggle to hit. Recov makes it effortless around training: all 20 amino acids, pre-digested and absorbed in minutes, so what you eat actually gets used — with no bloat.



Recov

The science-led recovery formula

- All 20 amino acids — a complete profile
- Pre-digested & absorbed in ~15–20 minutes
- An easy way to top up protein around training
- No bloat — built by a scientist, formulation first

Flexible diet, faster recovery.

Build your macros around real life, then give your recovery the edge. Start your first bottle of Recov.

[Shop Recov →](#)

[Learn more](#)

Pair Recov with your plan. If your recovery doesn't feel sharper, we'll make it right — just reach out.

Want your macros calculated and coached for you? Daniel works with a small number of clients each intake — details inside your Recov welcome email.



Flexible Dieting 101 — Eat the Foods You Love, Hit Your Goals

with Daniel Delahunty

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